



FACULTY OF COMPUTING

SEMESTER 2 2025/2026

SECP3213 - BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE

SECTION 2

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Industry Talk Report

Bridging Data & Decisions:

The Role of Data Governance and Data Management in Modern Business

Speaker: Mr. Faiz Fablillah

Date: 20 May 2026

Venue: BK1, N28, Faculty of Computing

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1. Introduction

Mr. Faiz Fablillah, Senior Practitioner in the field of Data and AI Governance, has been delivering a talk on the industry topic “Bridging Data & Decisions: The Role of Data Governance and Data Management in Modern Business Intelligence”. The aim of the talk was to get the audience acquainted with the concepts of Data Governance and Data Management in the context of modern Business Intelligence and how they enable trusted decision making. The topic is tremendously relevant to BI, as dashboards and reports can only be useful when used with accurate, secure, well-documented, and reliable data. The report guideline also suggests linking the talk to the Business Intelligence concepts and business in today's times.

2. Key Takeaways

The key takeaway from this talk was that Business Intelligence is more of a practice than just making dashboards. It's easy to make a professional impression with a dashboard, but if the information it reflects is flawed or handled inappropriately, so will the decisions it leads to. The speaker highlighted that data governance is the link between raw data and decisions that can be trusted.

The speaker also provided details on the distinction between data management and data governance. The emphasis on data management is on the proper handling of data using processes, systems, and practices. Data Governance is about the governance rules, decision-making, ownership, and policies on how data is managed. Governance determines the rules, and management implements the rules.

One more major lesson learnt was the importance of data quality. To create good BI, it requires accurate, complete, consistent, timely, valid, and unique data. Failure of any of these can lead to an erroneous BI result. The speaker also spoke about metadata and data lineage. Metadata gives users insight into what the data represents, who owns it and how it is organized; lineage provides information about the origin of a number and how it has changed.

Data security, access control, and compliance were also discussed. Not every data shall be accessible to everybody, particularly information that is related to personal sensitivity. The significance of this is such that in Malaysia, the organizations have to comply with the rules and regulations, including the Personal Data Protection Act 2010 (PDPA). Thus, accessing the data should be balanced with the privacy and security concerns of the BI professionals.

Case studies of real-world applications were also presented – such as banking, telecoms, and healthcare. These examples demonstrated how data governance can help minimize reporting inaccuracies, boost trust in dashboards, and make better business decisions. The speaker also discussed the transition from manual governance to AI-driven governance, highlighting the role of AI in data quality checks, anomaly detection, access control, and compliance monitoring. But still, there is a need for human input because man remains the one with the final say on the decision-making process, ethics, and judgment.

3. Reflection and Critical Insights

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One of the largest take-home messages was that BI is only useful when it's based on accurate data. This relates closely to the topics we studied in class related to ETL, Data Warehouse, Dashboards, and Decision Support, as all of these elements are directly reliant on good data. I always had the perception that BI is all about visualization and reporting, but the talk highlighted issues related to governance, metadata, lineage, and data quality. To my mind, analytics engineering and data governance are growing to be very important as companies now have a strong need to rely upon data for decision-making. The talk also got me interested in the possibility of how AI can be used to help with data governance and remain within the realm of human responsibility for ethical and impactful decisions.

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From the talk from Mr Faiz, I learnt that without strict governance rules such as mandatory data quality, metadata recording and traceability tracking, an efficient ETL process will only transmit bad data faster. Mr Faiz emphasises on the traceability of tracking data is particularly important, if there is an abnormality in the final Power BI data board or report, it is equally important to be able to track the source and the conversion logic itself. In addition, the discussion on PDPA compliance and access control further shows that security must be integrated directly into the pipeline rather than after the fact. My understanding of how governance links the original technical process with reliable business decision-making will become the mindset I will carry forward in projects and upcoming internships.

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From Mr. Faiz's talk, I know that business intelligence is not only about creating dashboards and visual reports. It is also about the data behind them being accurate, reliable and governed. Moreover, this talk taught me that concepts like data governance, data quality, metadata management, data lineage, security, and compliance are important to make informed decisions. Furthermore, I understand that even though there are all the necessary tools, poor governance can still result in wrong decision-making in businesses. For my further work with business intelligence, I will focus more on data quality, documentation, and tracing instead of merely focusing on dashboard creation.

4. Conclusion

The talk, in a nutshell, provides a clear concept of how data governance and data management benefit Business Intelligence. It demonstrated that there is more to trusted decisions than pretty dashboards, it's good data quality, documentation, security, ownership, and governance. I even had a rethink of future career options with data! Data professionals also require technical abilities (like SQL, Python, and dashboard development) and an understanding of governance, compliance, communication, and business context. It was an inspiring session in which I was encouraged to apply governance thinking in my future academic work and preparation for my career.